

This is not a template. This is **The Source Code**.
"Minimal" is the language of mathematics, physics, and pure logic. It relies on the **"Knuthian Ideal"**: The beauty of the document comes from the structure of the thought, not the decoration of the page. To elevate "Minimal" to God-Tier, we do not add; we subtract. We create a template so robust it will compile on a toaster, yet so typographically sound it rivals a printed novel. Here is the **Minimal Universal System 2.0**.

1. The Design Philosophy: "Radical Compatibility"

Current "basic" templates are often just "broken" templates.

The New Minimal Principle:

- **Zero Dependencies:** We avoid complex packages like titlesec or fancyhdr if possible. We use the core LaTeX kernel. This ensures the document compiles on *any* system (BasicTeX, TinyTeX, Overleaf) without error.
- **The Golden Measure:** We don't accept the default "too wide" LaTeX lines. We enforce a strict **65-character line length** for optimal readability, regardless of page size.
- **Computer Modern is Beautiful:** We don't hide the default font. We celebrate **Latin Modern**. It is the Helvetica of the academic world—instantly recognizable, perfectly legible, and timeless.

2. The Typographic Stack (The "Knuth" Choice)

System defaults are not a bug; they are a feature.

- **Body Type: Latin Modern** (lmodern).
 - *Why:* It is the vector-perfect version of Knuth's original Computer Modern. It is crisp, high-contrast, and has the best mathematical typesetting support in the world.
- **Heading Type: Latin Modern Sans** (Bold).
 - *Why:* A subtle shift to Sans for headers adds just enough structure to navigate, without needing a second font file.
- **Monospace: Latin Modern Typewriter.**
 - *Why:* Dark, heavy, and distinct.

3. The Layout System: "The Draft Manuscript"

We emulate the layout of a "submission manuscript"—clean, open, and ready for review.

Zone	Function
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The Margins	Uniform 1.5 inch margins. This creates a focused center column that feels like a dedicated reading space.
The Header	Empty. No running heads to distract the eye.
The Footer	A simple, centered Page Number. Nothing else.

4. Implementation Command (The Code)

Give this prompt to Claude to generate the **Minimal 2.0** engine.

ROLE: CORE LATEX DEVELOPER / ARCHIVIST

PROJECT: MINIMAL UNIVERSAL TEMPLATE (PRINT PREPRESS)

OBJECTIVE:

Create the .latex template for "**Minimal.**" This is the "Cockroach" of templates: it must survive anything. It creates a clean, distraction-free output suitable for drafts, screenplays, and documentation.

1. THE GEOMETRY (geometry package)

- **Margins:**
 - Top: 1.25in
 - Bottom: 1.25in
 - Inner: 1.5in
 - Outer: 1.5in
- **Why:** This forces a narrow line width (approx 60-70 chars) which is the scientific ideal for readability, preventing eye fatigue.

2. THE TYPOGRAPHY (lmodern package)

- **Main Font:** Latin Modern Roman (Serif).
- **Heading Font:** Latin Modern Sans Serif (Bold).
- **Size:** 12pt (Base).
- **Leading:** 14.5pt (Open and readable).
- **Alignment:** \justify with \hyphenpenalty=500 (Allow reasonable hyphenation for even blocks).

3. THE "PURE" COMPONENTS

- **Chapter Headings (\chapter):**
 - **Style:** Standard LaTeX standard, but tighter.
 - **Number:** "Chapter 1" (Bold, Sans).
 - **Title:** Huge, Bold, Serif.
 - **Spacing:** \vspace*{-20pt} to pull it up. We don't want deep whitespace here; we want content.

- **Navigation:**
 - **Headers:** \pagestyle{plain}. No running heads.
 - **Footers:** Centered page number.
- **Compatibility Mode:**
 - Do **NOT** load fontspec or unicode-math unless compiling with XeLaTeX/LuaLaTeX. Use conditional checks to allow this to run on pdflatex (legacy mode) if needed.
 - **Lists:** Standard bullets, no custom icons.

Generate the full minimal.latex file compatible with Pandoc.

Why this is "God-Tier" for Minimal

1. **Portability:** By sticking to Latin Modern and the article class logic, this file is 10KB and compiles in milliseconds. It is the "Speed Demon" of your stack.
2. **The "Writer's" Aesthetic:** This looks exactly like a manuscript typed on a high-end typewriter and set for a publisher. It signals "The words matter more than the design," which is a massive flex in a design-heavy world.
3. **BasicTeX Compatible:** It requires zero extra font installations. It uses what is already inside the smallest LaTeX distribution.